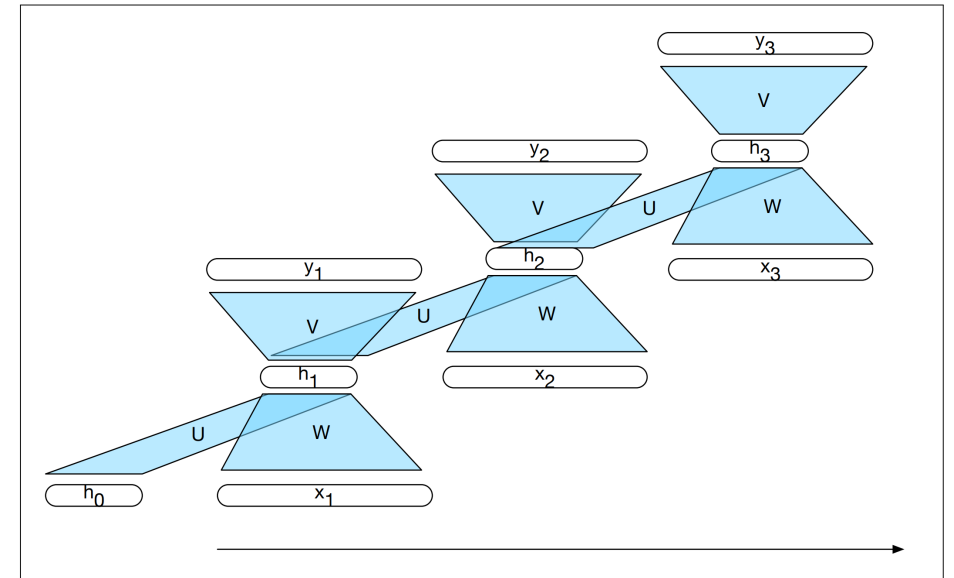


A word on Backpropagation Through Time

- In order to train the network, we need to decide what output of the network we would like to compare to the gold standard and what loss function to use
- Even if the recurrent function R and the output function O are shallow (e.g., a single affine function), the computation graph may be deep due to the recurrence
- It is common practice to limit (truncate) the number of iterations
- We will see an example later



Reminder: Loss Functions

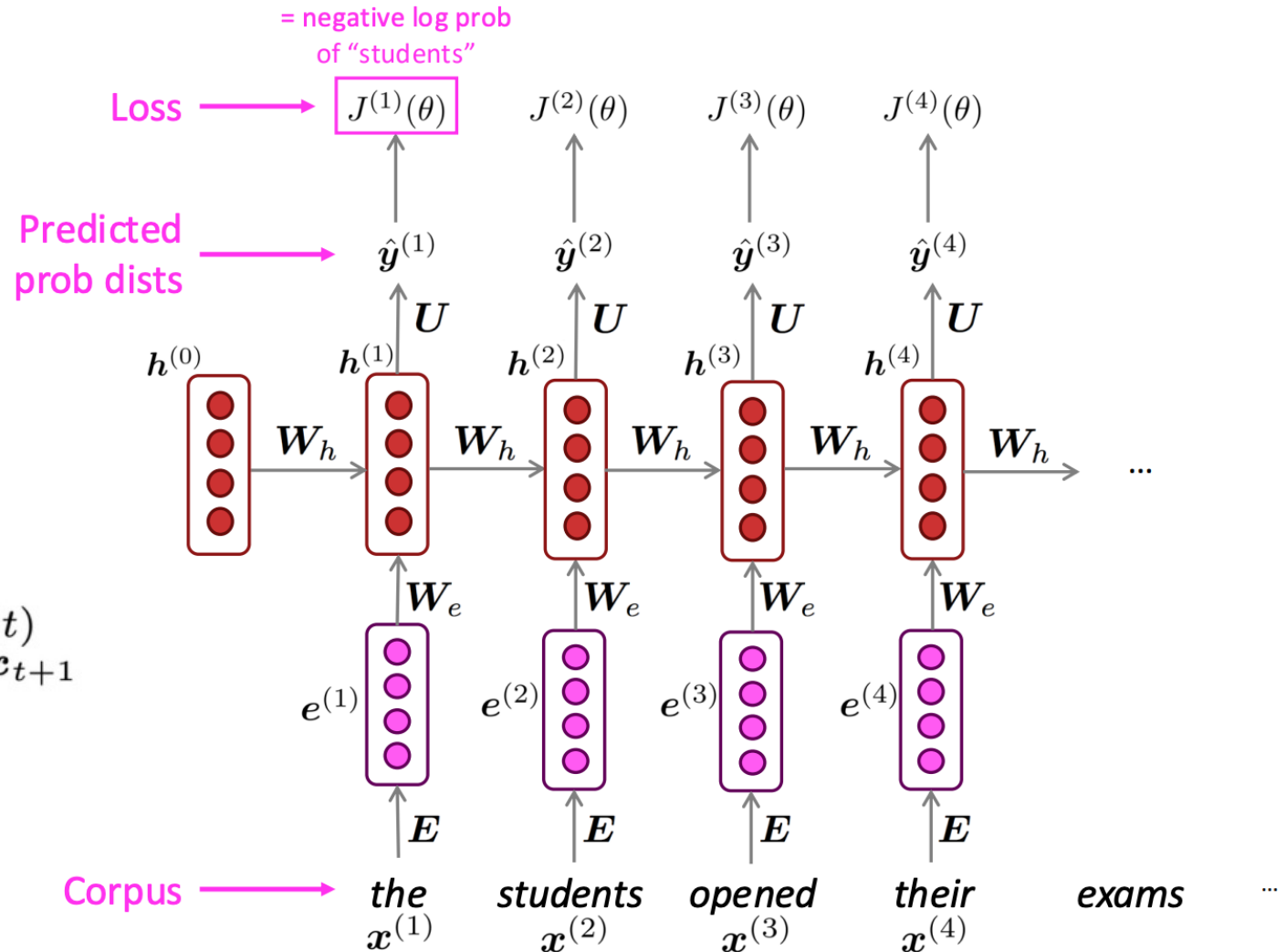
- Training is done by defining a loss function (i.e. a function that determines how “bad” a classification is relative to the gold standard)
- The network then attempts to minimize the empirical risk. For a sample $S=\{x_1, \dots, x_m\}$ with gold standard labels $\{y_1, \dots, y_m\}$, the empirical risk is:

$$\frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \ell(\theta; (x_i, y_i))$$

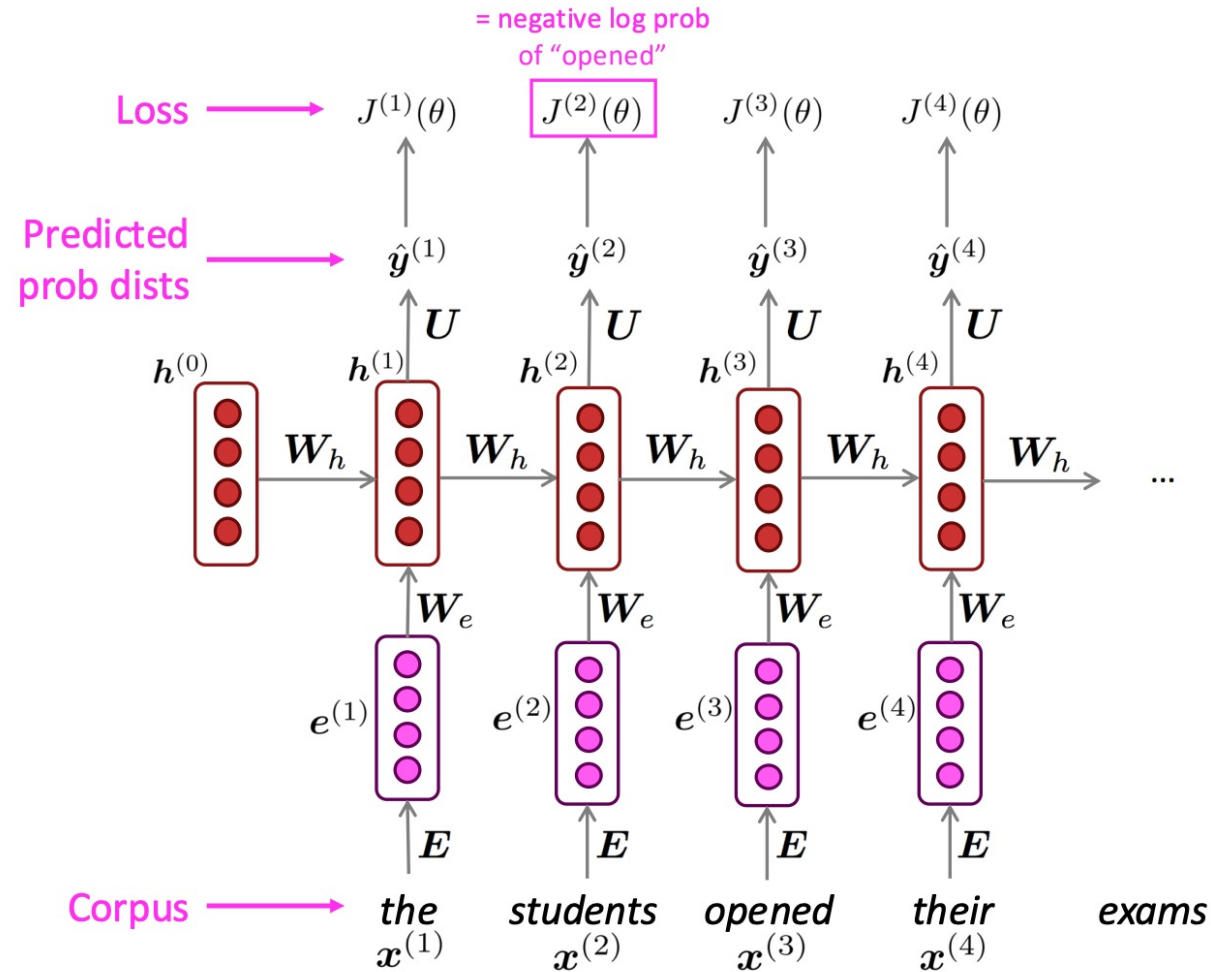
Training RNN LMs

- Neural language models are generally trained to maximize the sum of the predicted log-probabilities of the correct words
 - Cross-entropy loss

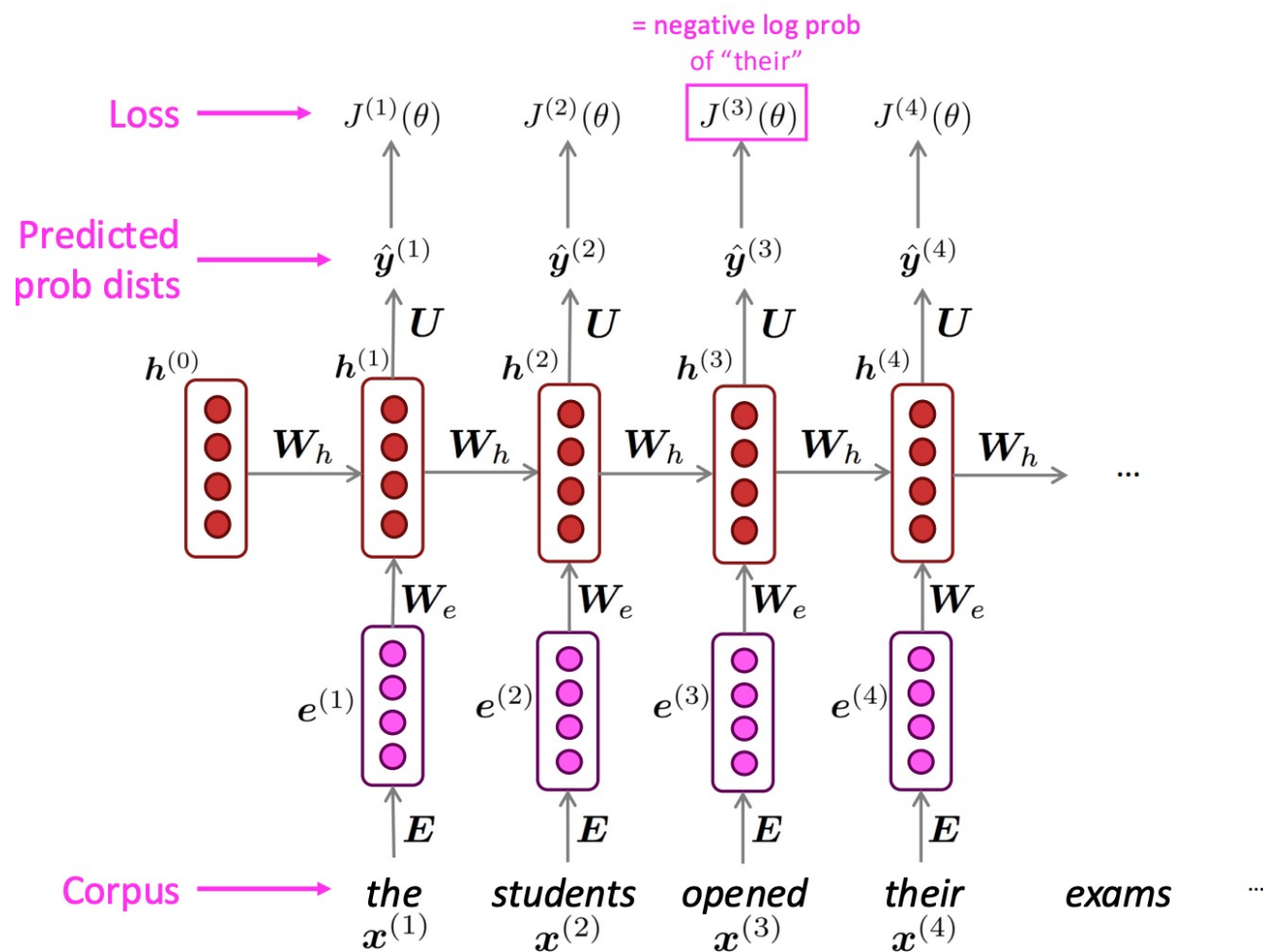
$$J(\theta) = \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T J^{(t)}(\theta) = \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T -\log \hat{y}_{x_{t+1}}^{(t)}$$



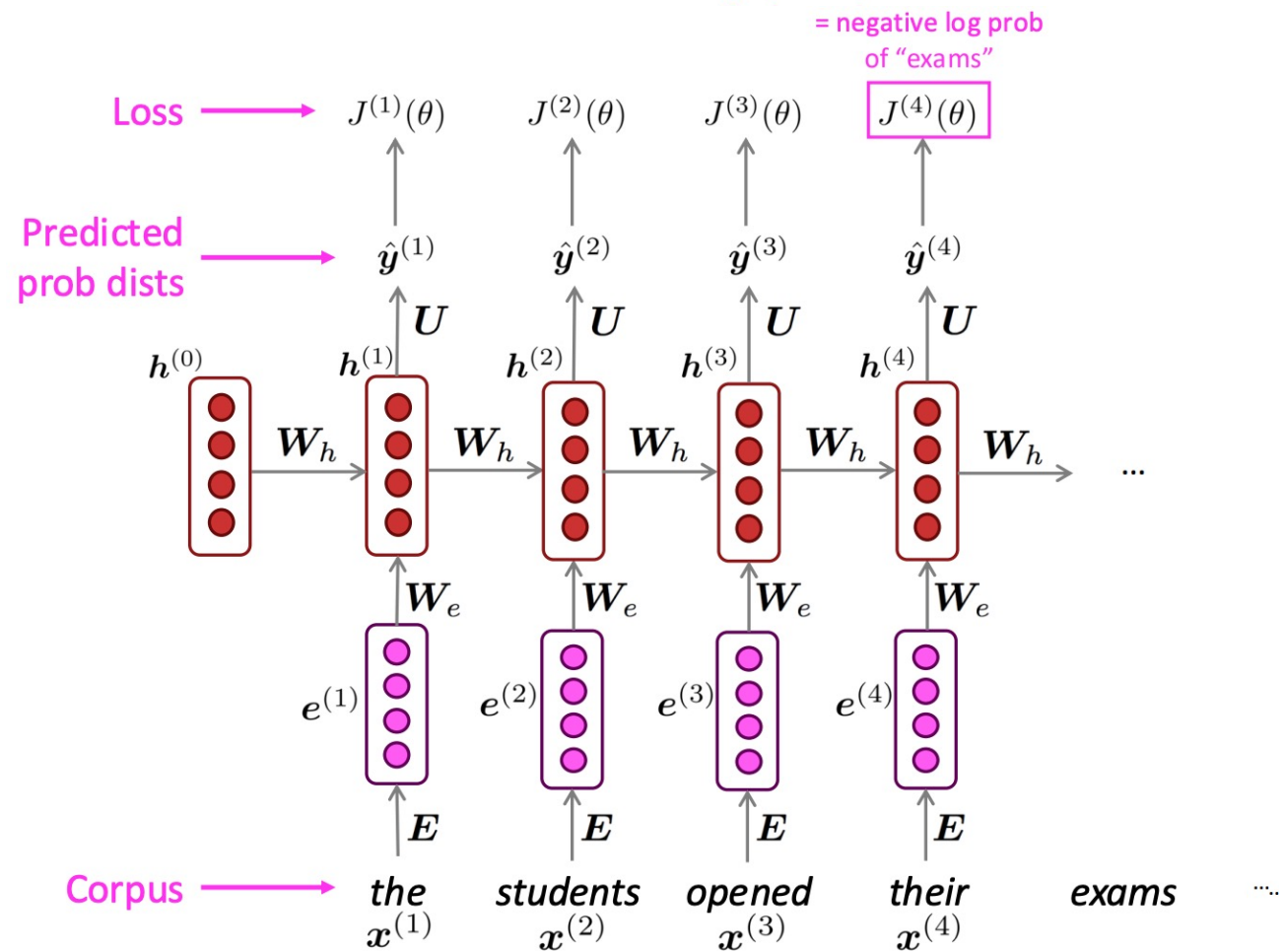
Training RNN LMs



Training RNN LMs



Training RNN LMs



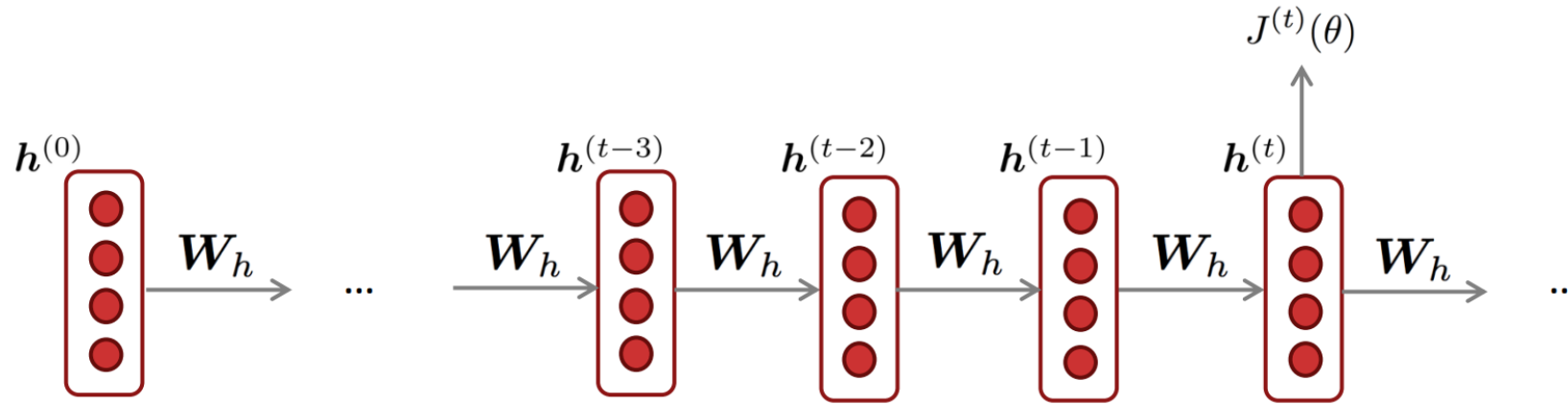
Training RNN Language Model

- However:
 - Computing loss and gradients across entire corpus at once is too expensive (memory-wise)!

$$J(\theta) = \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T J^{(t)}(\theta)$$

- In practice, consider as a sentence (or a document)

Backpropagation for RNNs

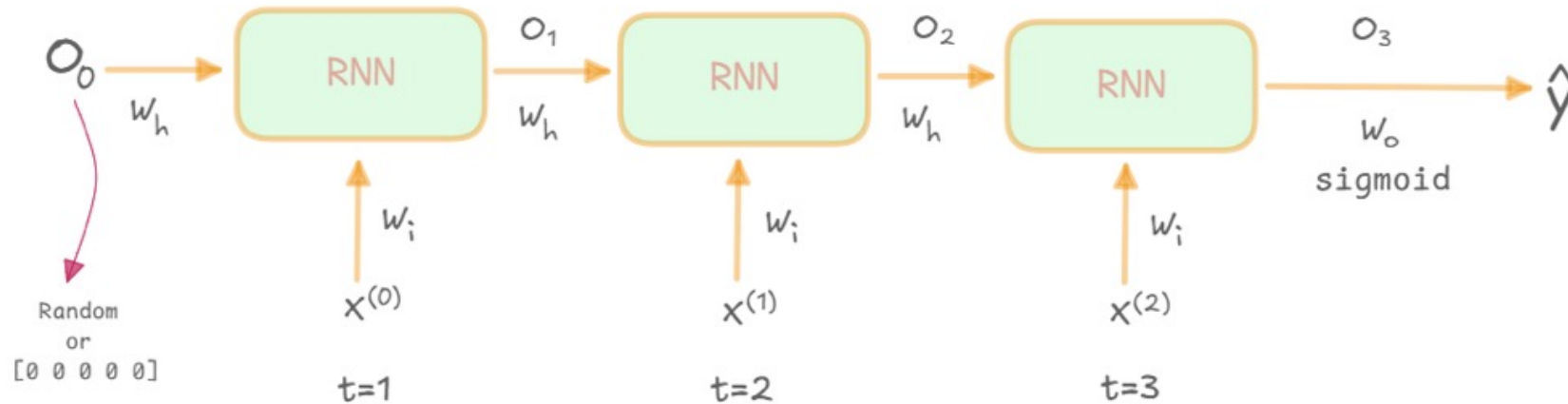


Question: What's the derivative of $J^{(t)}(\theta)$ w.r.t. the **repeated** weight matrix W_h ?

Answer:
$$\frac{\partial J^{(t)}}{\partial W_h} = \sum_{i=1}^t \frac{\partial J^{(i)}}{\partial W_h} \Big|_{(i)}$$

“The gradient w.r.t. a repeated weight is the sum of the gradient w.r.t. each time it appears”

Backpropagation for RNNs: Simple Case



$$O_1 = f \left(X_i^{(0)} W_i + O_0 W_h \right)$$

$$O_2 = f \left(X_i^{(1)} W_i + O_1 W_h \right)$$

$$O_3 = f \left(X_i^{(2)} W_i + O_2 W_h \right)$$

$$\hat{y} = \sigma (O_3 W_o)$$

Backpropagation for RNNs: Simple Case

- Assume L is the loss

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\mathcal{L}}{dW_h} &= \frac{d\mathcal{L}}{d\hat{y}} \cdot \frac{d\hat{y}}{dO_3} \cdot \frac{dO_3}{dW_h} \\ &+ \frac{d\mathcal{L}}{d\hat{y}} \cdot \frac{d\hat{y}}{dO_3} \cdot \frac{dO_3}{dO_2} \cdot \frac{dO_2}{dW_h} \\ &+ \frac{d\mathcal{L}}{d\hat{y}} \cdot \frac{d\hat{y}}{dO_3} \cdot \frac{dO_3}{dO_2} \cdot \frac{dO_2}{dO_1} \cdot \frac{dO_1}{dW_h} \end{aligned}$$

